CloudBridge Technologies: Microsoft 365 Administration Lab

This report documents the setup and administration of a Microsoft 365 trial tenant for CloudBridge Technologies, a fictional IT services company in Johannesburg. Each section shows the configuration with screenshots and a short description of what was done.

Tenant baseline and user accounts

The tenant started with a single administrator account. The fictional employees were then added in bulk, and Office 365 E5 licenses were assigned to all nine accounts.

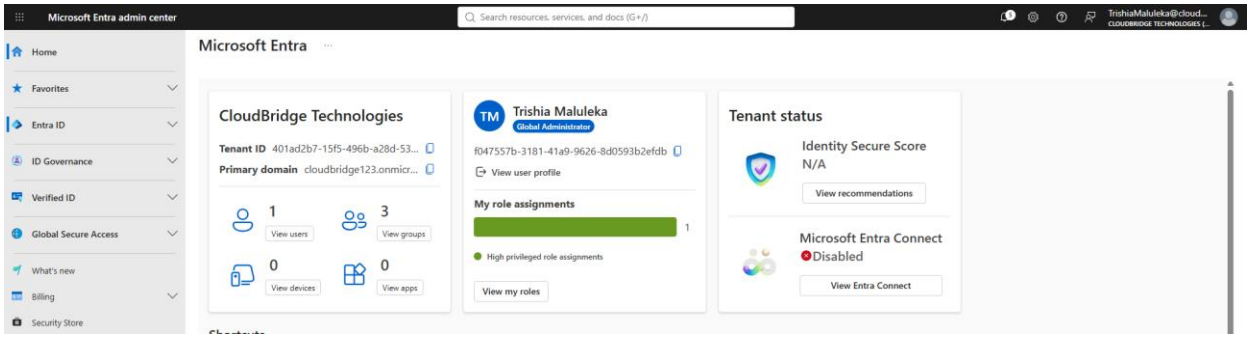


Figure 1: Microsoft Entra admin center overview for the CloudBridge Technologies tenant. The baseline state before any configuration: one user (the Global Administrator), three default groups, no devices or applications registered, and the Entra Free plan.

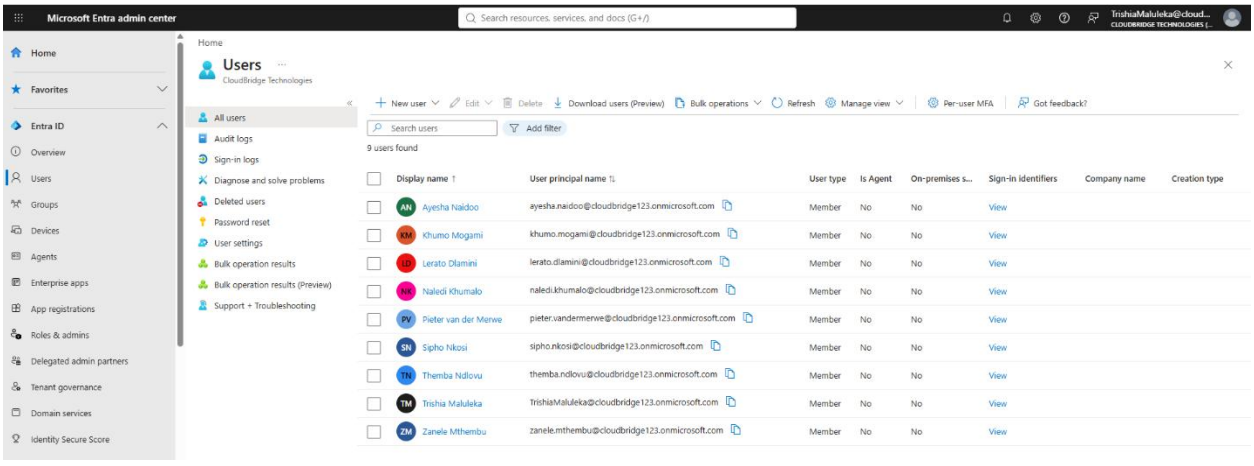


Figure 2: Entra admin center user list after bulk onboarding, showing all nine CloudBridge Technologies employees.

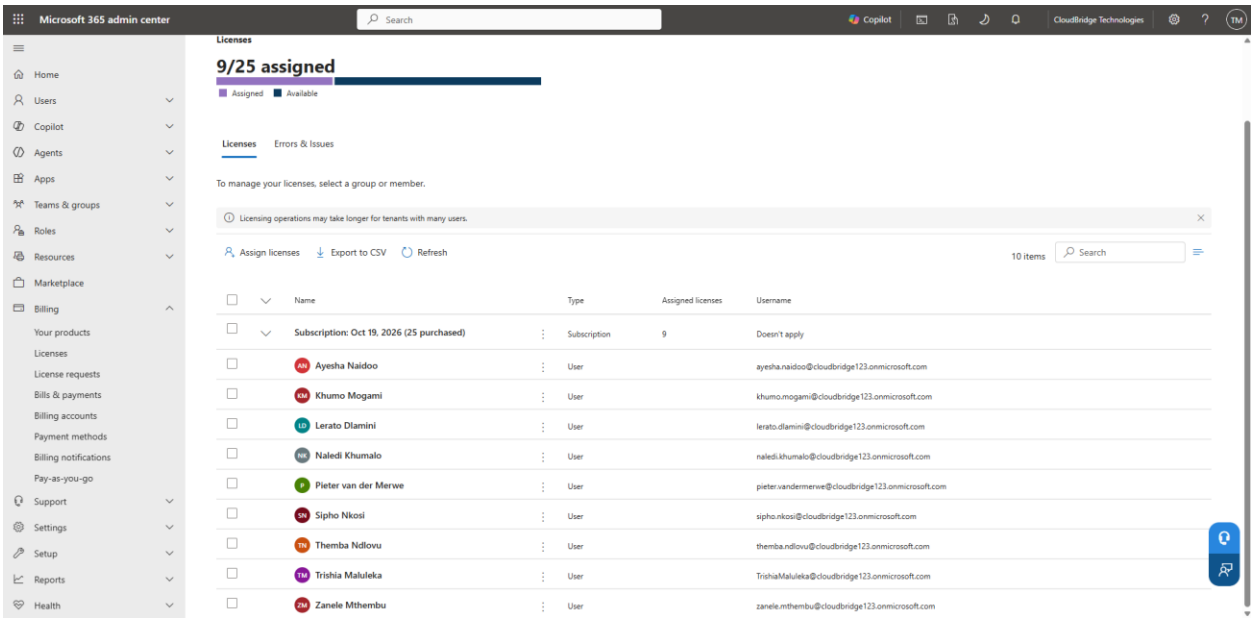


Figure 3: Microsoft 365 admin center license view showing Office 365 E5 assigned to all nine employees (9 of 25 licenses used).

Security and emergency access

Multifactor authentication is enforced for all accounts and security defaults are enabled on the tenant.

An emergency access (break-glass) account was also created. It is a cloud-only Global Administrator account that is not used day to day, and it gives a way back into the tenant if the main administrator account is locked out or misconfigured. It is unlicensed and belongs to no groups. Its credentials are not recorded in this report.

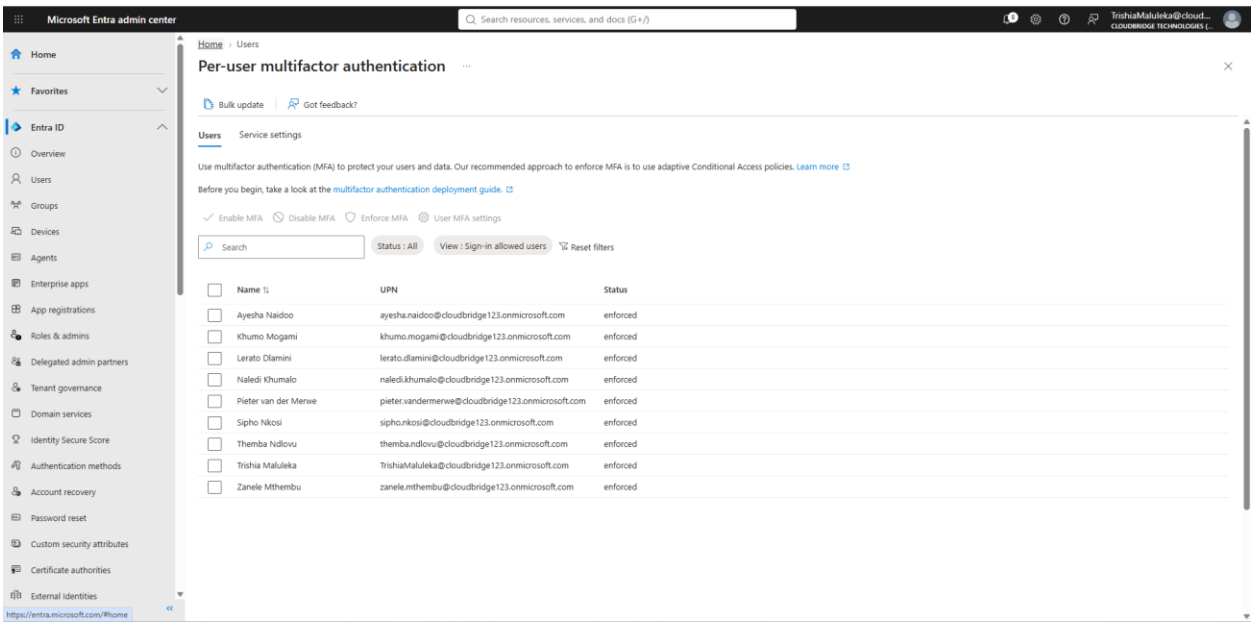


Figure 4: Per-user multifactor authentication status in Entra, showing MFA enforced for all nine CloudBridge Technologies accounts.

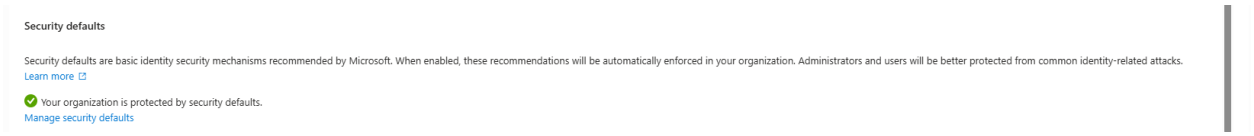


Figure 5: Microsoft Entra tenant properties showing security defaults enabled for the CloudBridge Technologies organization.

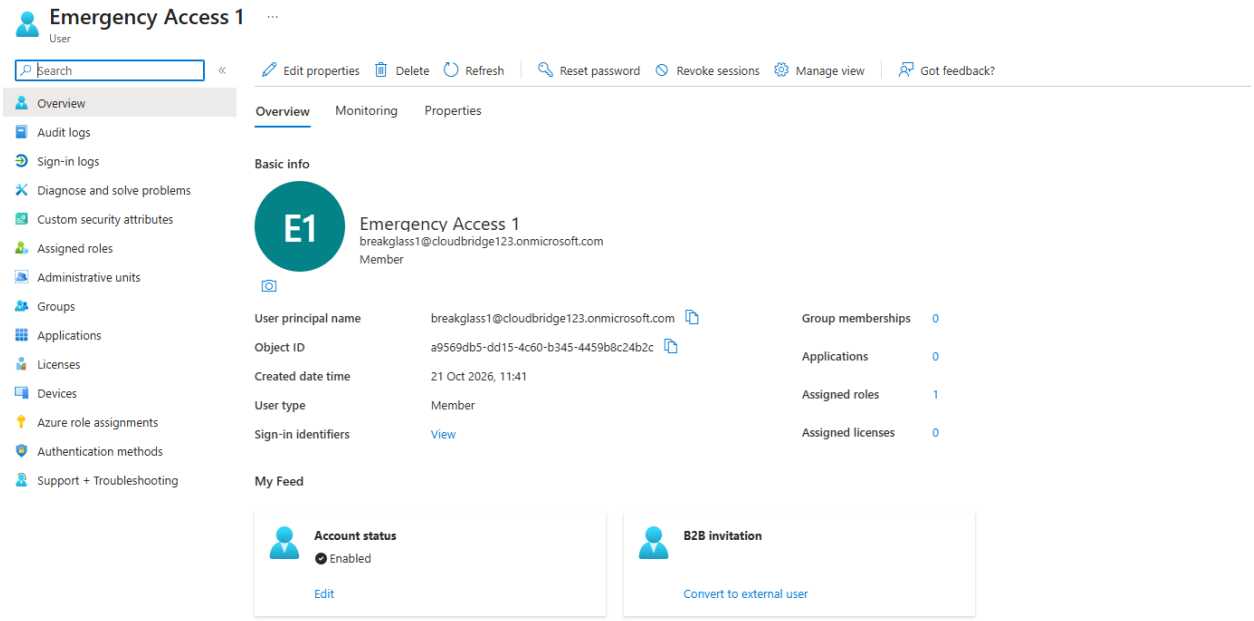


Figure 6: Emergency access (break-glass) account in Entra, unlicensed and holding one administrative role (Global Administrator).

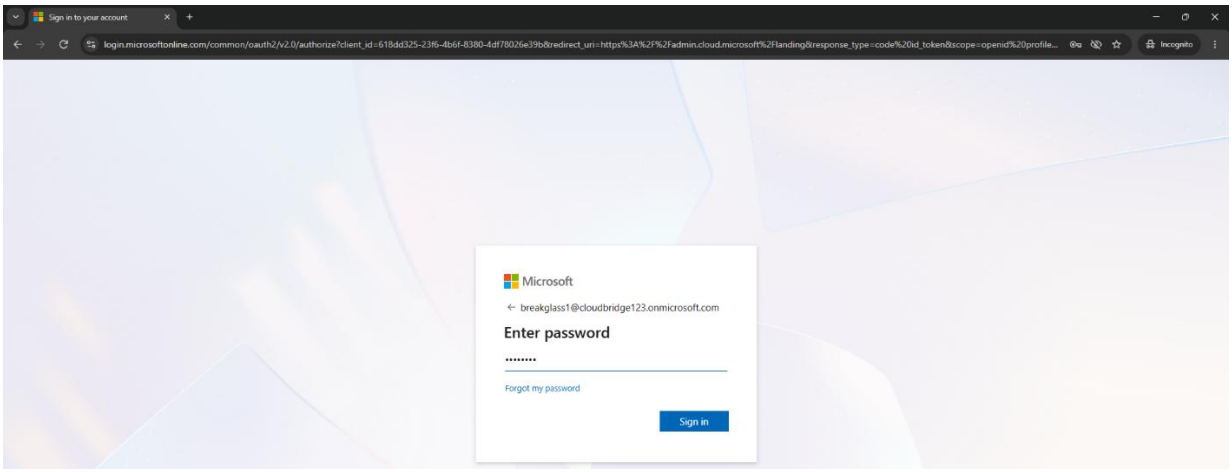


Figure 7: Sign-in test of the emergency access account in a private browser window: entering the account password.

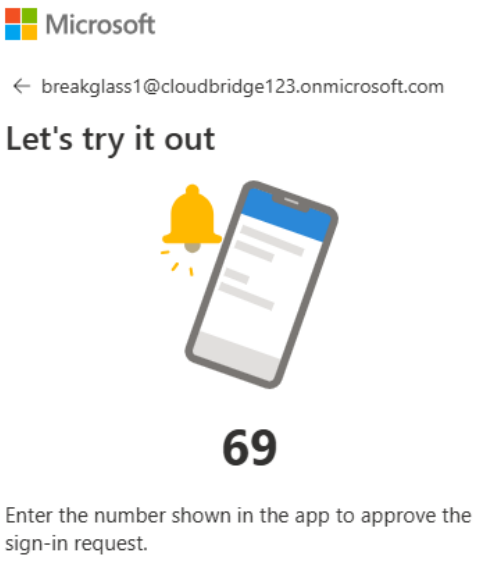


Figure 8: Number-matching prompt during MFA registration for the emergency access account.

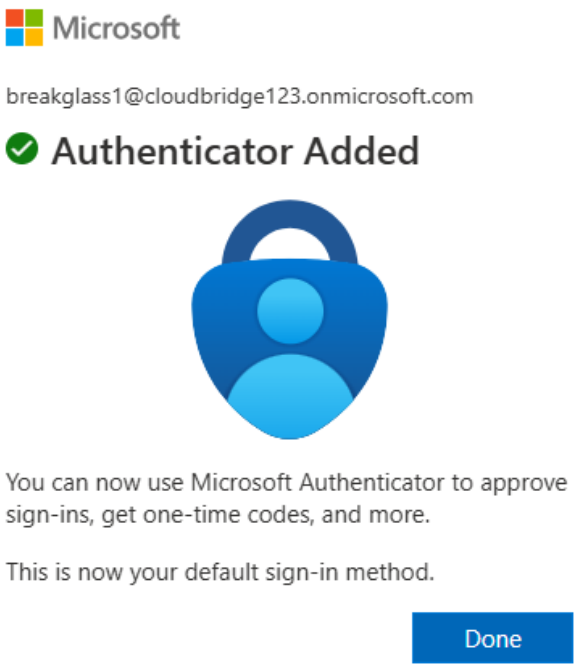


Figure 9: Microsoft Authenticator registered as the default sign-in method for the emergency access account.

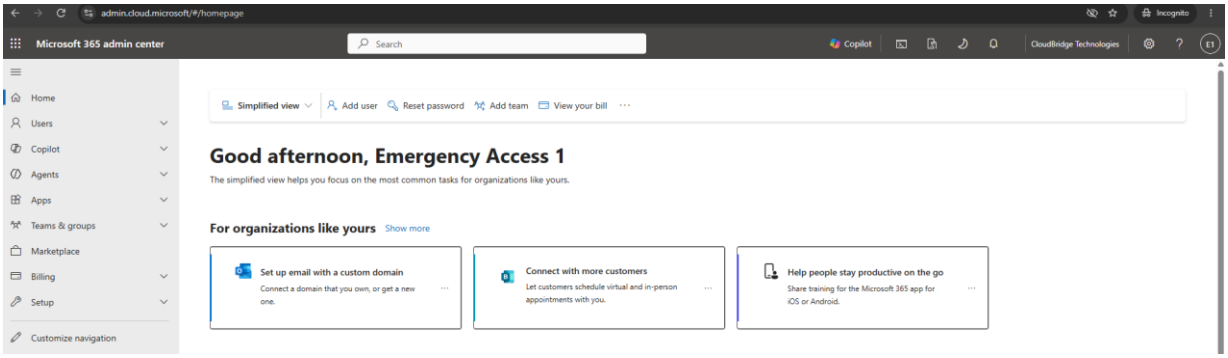


Figure 10: Emergency access account signed in to the Microsoft 365 admin center, confirming the account works.

Groups and roles

Security groups were created for each department, together with a Microsoft 365 group, a distribution list, and scoped administrator roles, following the principle of least privilege.

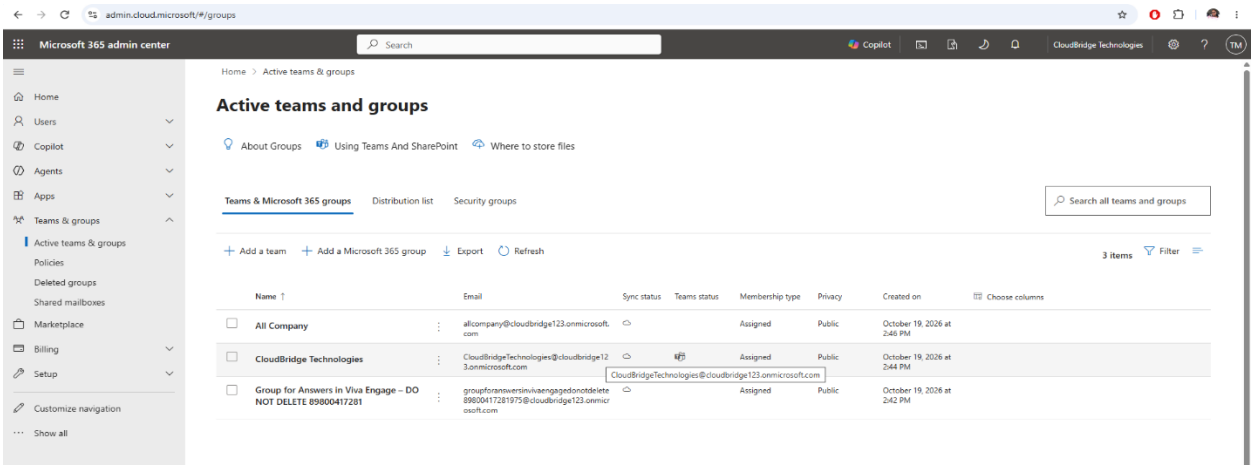


Figure 11: Default Microsoft 365 groups in the new tenant, before any custom groups were created.

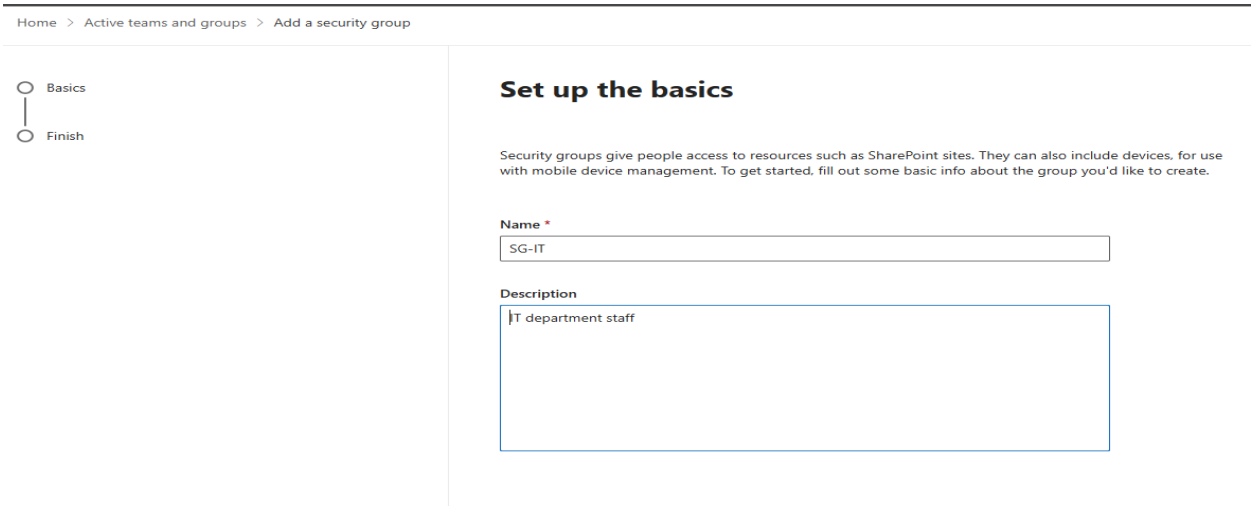


Figure 12: Creating the SG-IT security group in the Microsoft 365 admin center.

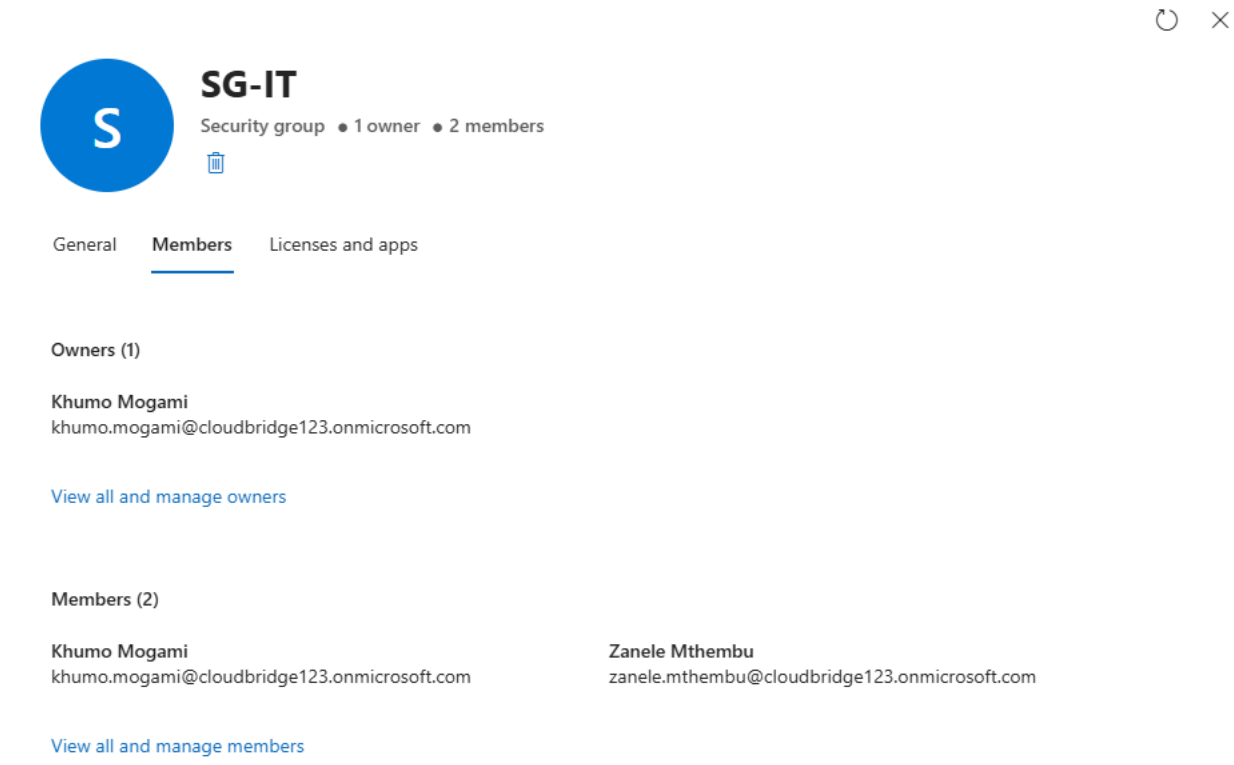


Figure 13: SG-IT membership showing one owner (Khumo Mogami) and two members (Khumo Mogami and Zanele Mthembu).

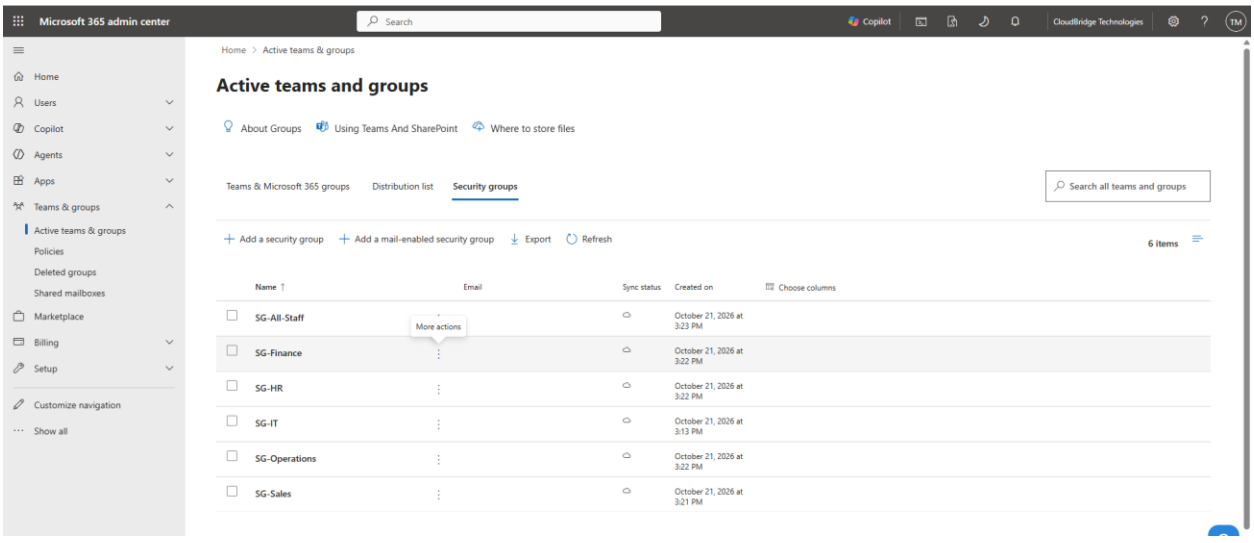


Figure 14: The six security groups: one per department (SG-IT, SG-Sales, SG-HR, SG-Finance, SG-Operations), each owned by its department head, plus SG-All-Staff for all employees.

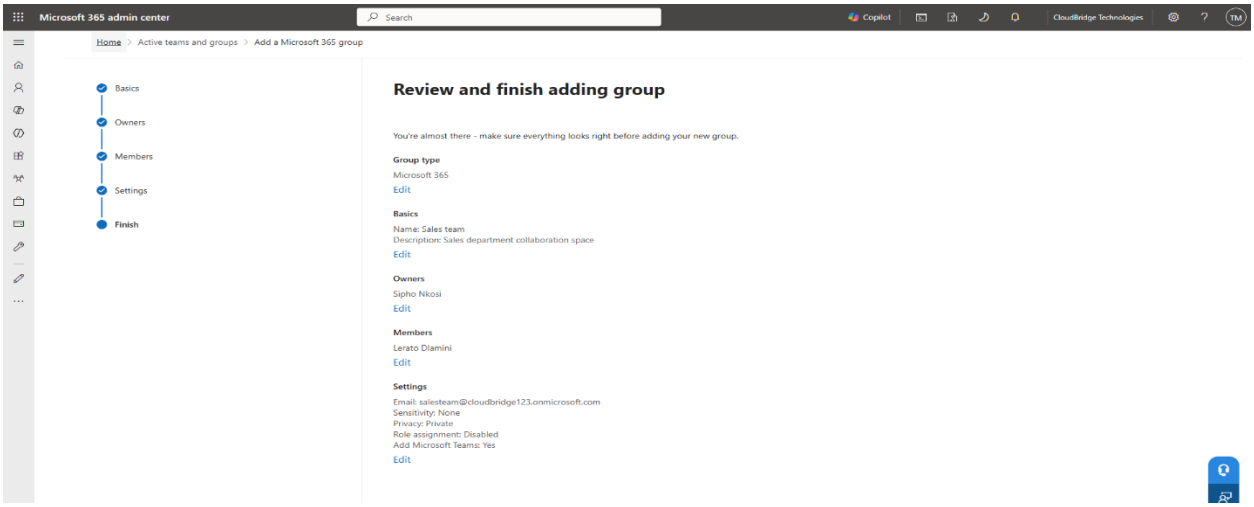


Figure 15: Review page for the Sales Team Microsoft 365 group, created under Active teams & groups > Add a Microsoft 365 group. Sipho Nkosi is the owner and Lerato Dlamini the member. The group is Private, so its content is limited to the sales team. It has the email address salesteam@cloudbridge123.onmicrosoft.com, and a Microsoft Teams team was added.

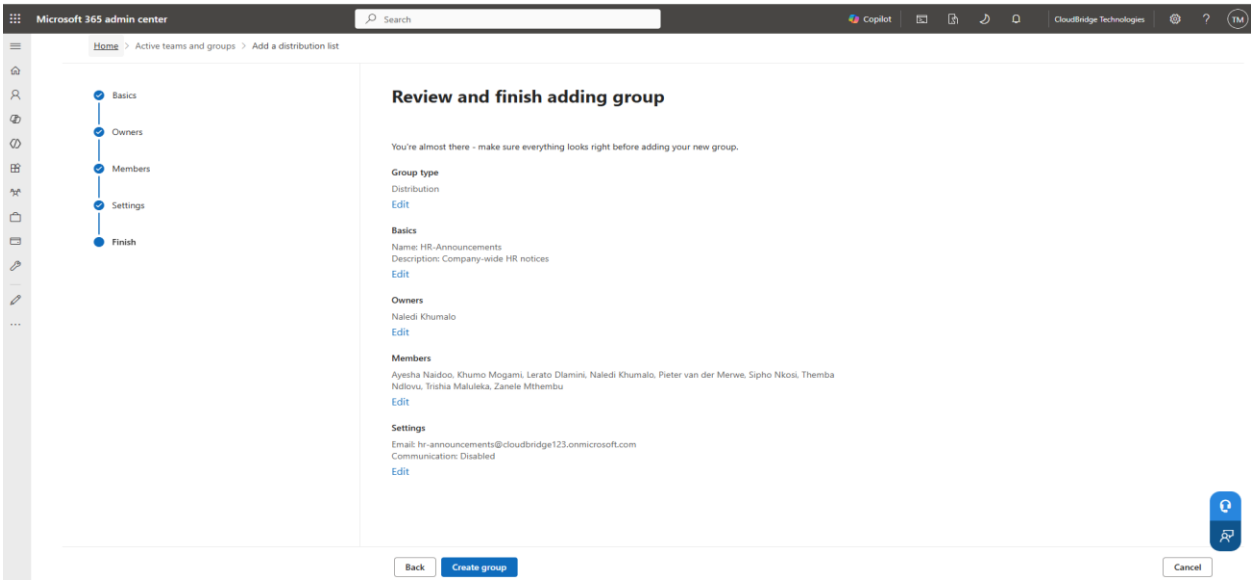


Figure 16: Review page for the HR-Announcements distribution list, owned by Naledi Khumalo, with all nine employees as members. External senders are disabled, and the list is used only to distribute HR communications by email.

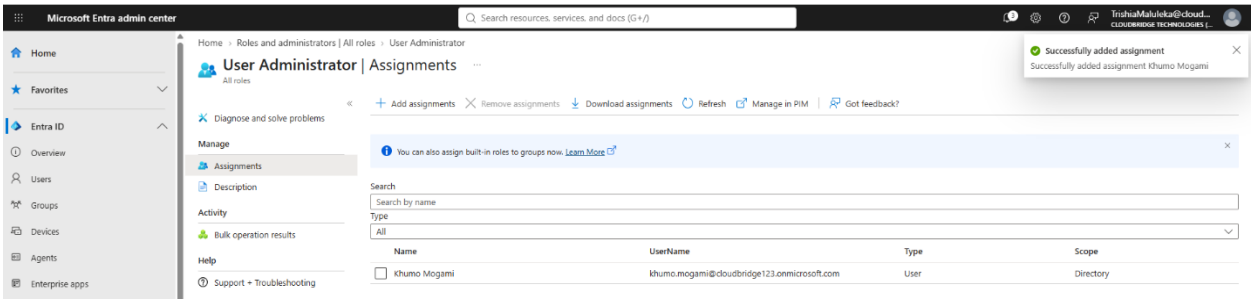


Figure 17: User Administrator role assigned to Khumo Mogami (Directory scope), giving the IT Administrator rights to manage users and groups without Global Administrator access.

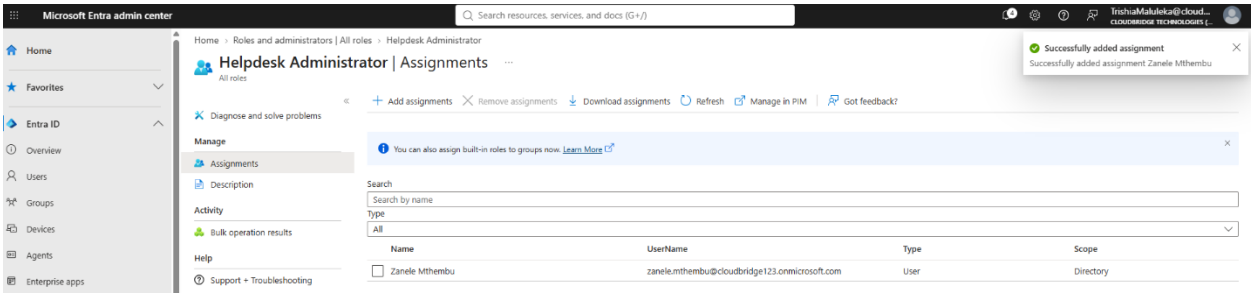


Figure 18: Helpdesk Administrator role assigned to Zanele Mthembu (Directory scope), allowing first-line password resets for non-administrator users.

Exchange Online

Mailboxes and mail delivery were checked, a shared mailbox was created with delegated permissions, and a mail flow rule was configured in the Exchange admin center.

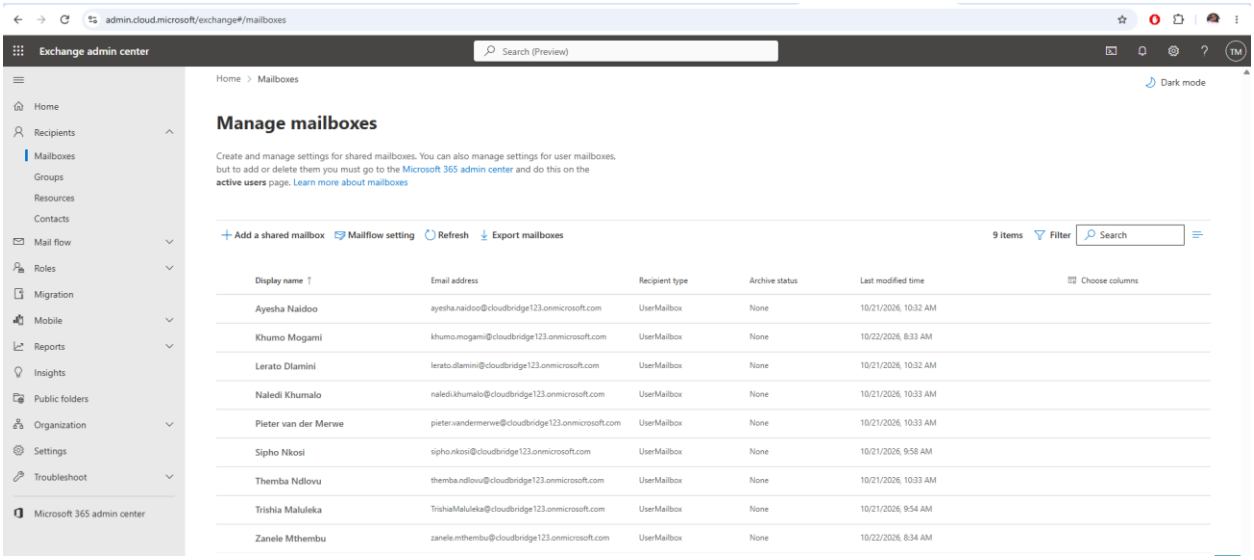


Figure 19: Exchange admin center, Recipients > Mailboxes, showing nine user mailboxes, one for each licensed employee. The emergency access account has no mailbox because it is unlicensed.

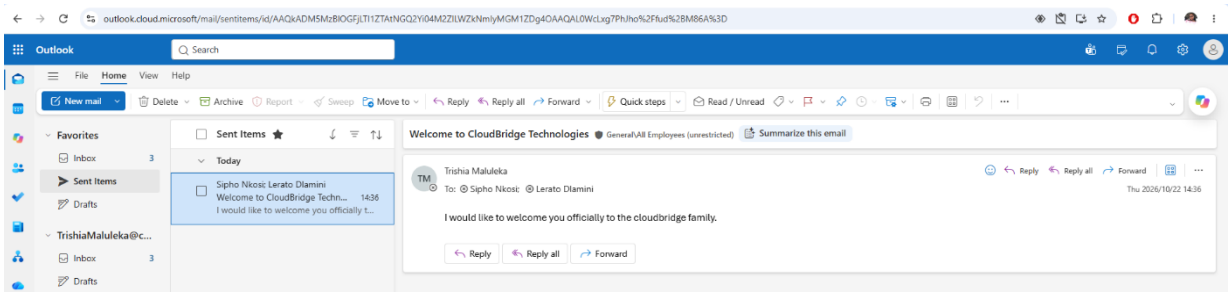


Figure 20: Welcome email sent from Trishia Maluleka's mailbox to Sipho Nkosi and Lerato Dlamini, shown in Outlook on the web.

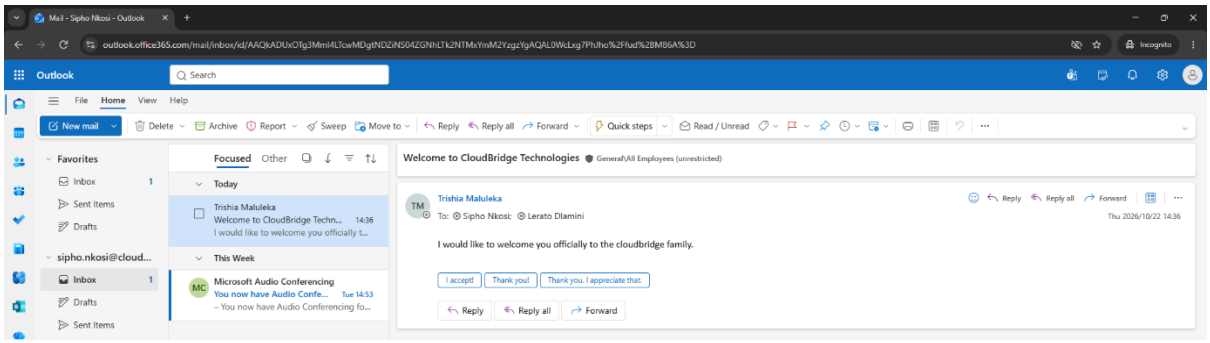


Figure 21: The same message received in Sipho Nkosi's inbox, opened in a private browser window, confirming delivery.

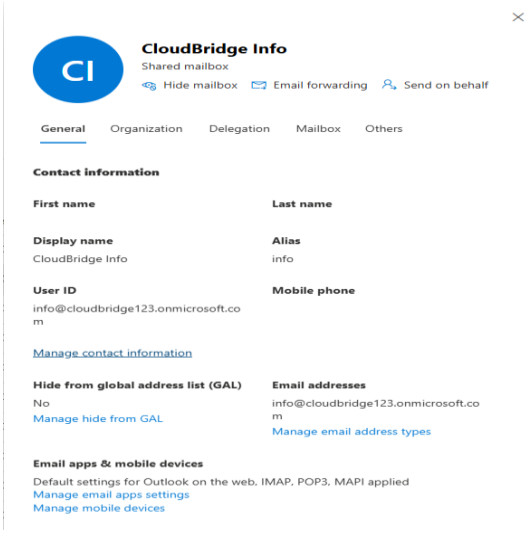


Figure 22: CloudBridge Info shared mailbox in the Exchange admin center, created under Recipients > Mailboxes > Add a shared mailbox, with the alias info. No license is required for a shared mailbox.

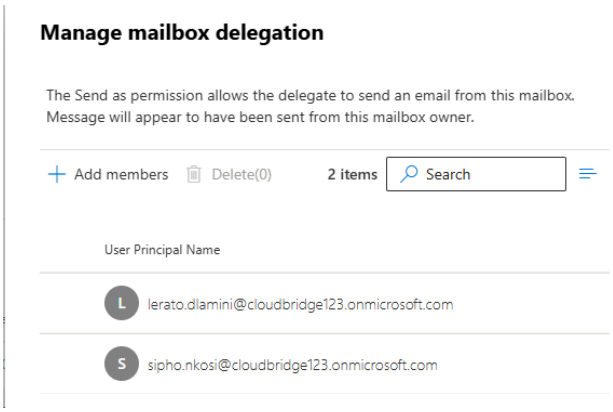


Figure 23: Send as permission for the CloudBridge Info shared mailbox granted to Sipho Nkosi and Lerato Dlamini, allowing them to send mail that appears to come from the shared mailbox.

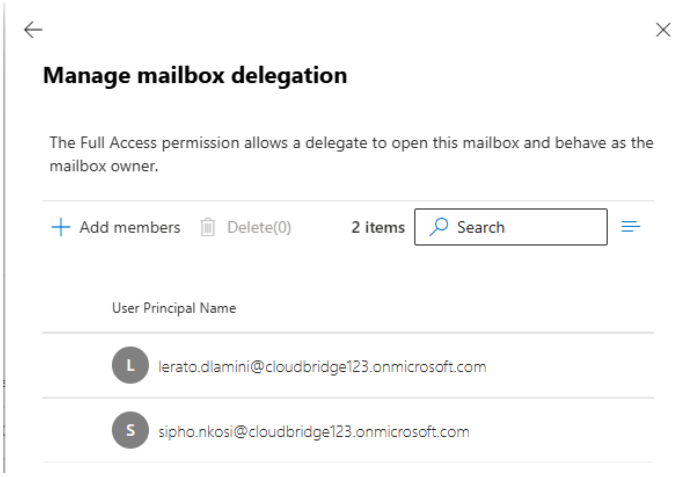


Figure 24: Full Access permission for the CloudBridge Info shared mailbox granted to Sipho Nkosi and Lerato Dlamini, allowing them to open the mailbox and read its mail.

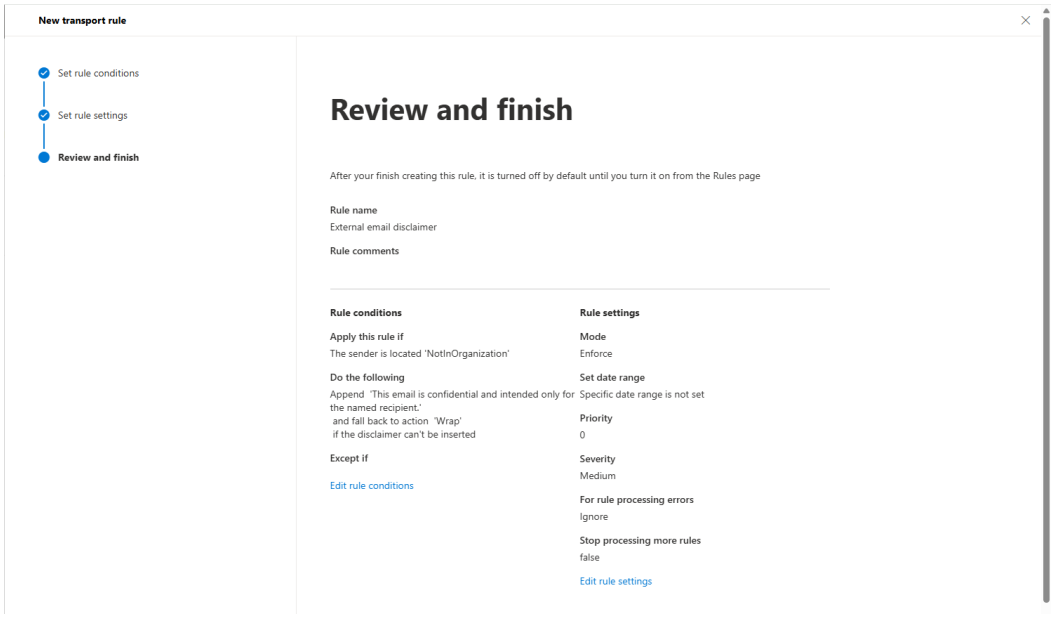


Figure 25: Review page for the External email disclaimer transport rule, which appends a confidentiality disclaimer and wraps the message if the text cannot be inserted. As configured here, the rule matches messages whose sender is outside the organization.

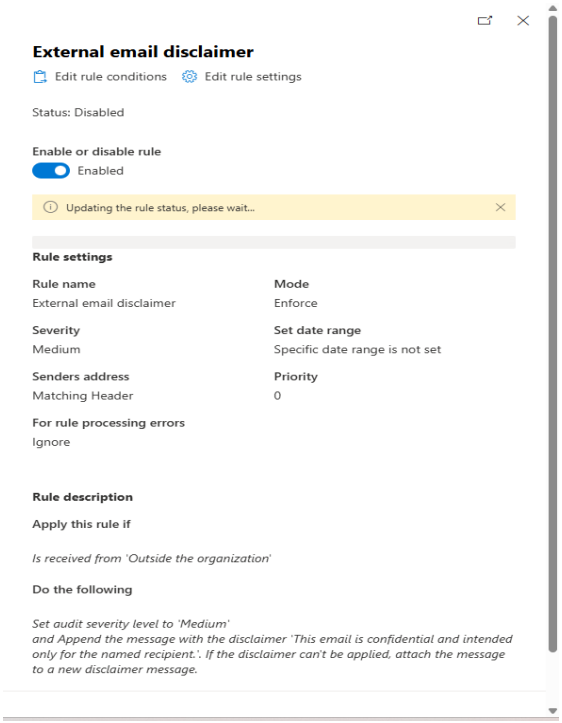


Figure 26: Details panel for the External email disclaimer rule in the Exchange admin center, showing Enforce mode, Medium severity, and the disclaimer text appended to matching messages.

Microsoft Teams

A Private team was created for each department. Each team is backed by a Microsoft 365 group and has its own SharePoint site.

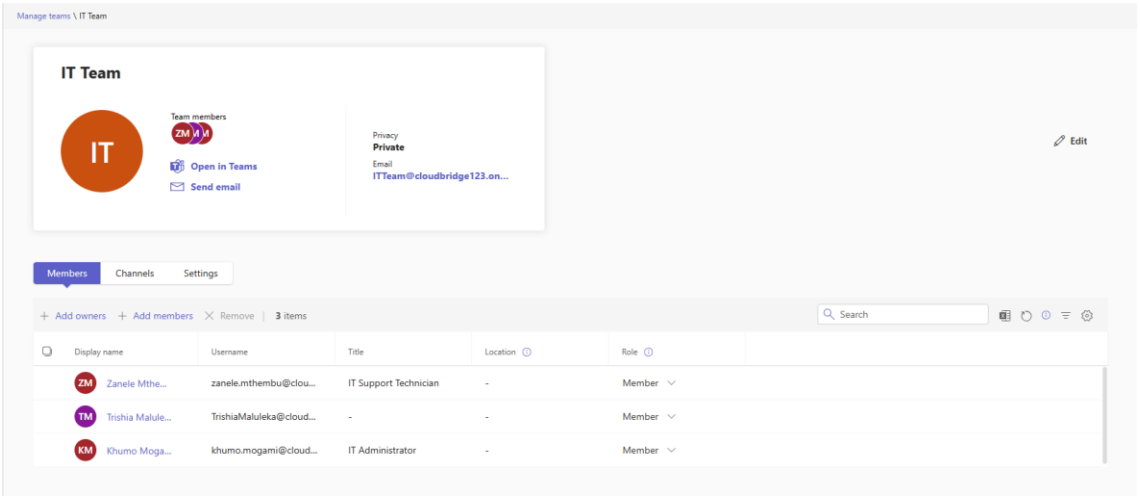


Figure 27: IT Team in the Teams admin center. The team is Private and has three members (Zanele Mthembu, Trishia Maluleka and Khumo Mogami), with its own SharePoint site and shared mailbox.

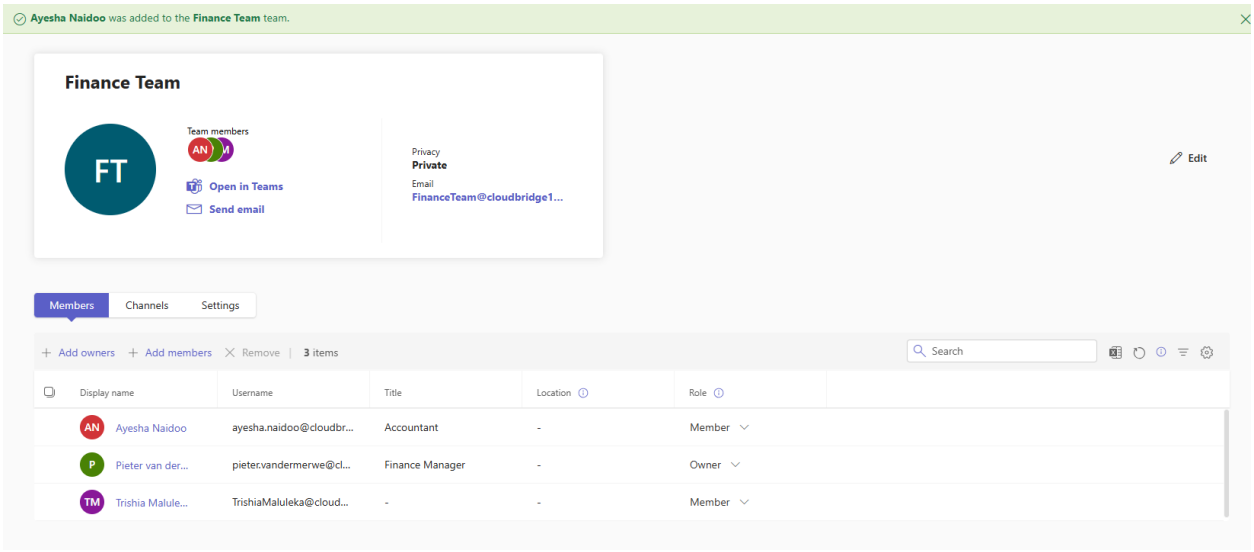


Figure 28: Finance Team, owned by Pieter van der Merwe, with Ayesha Naidoo and Trishia Maluleka as members. The confirmation banner shows a member being added.

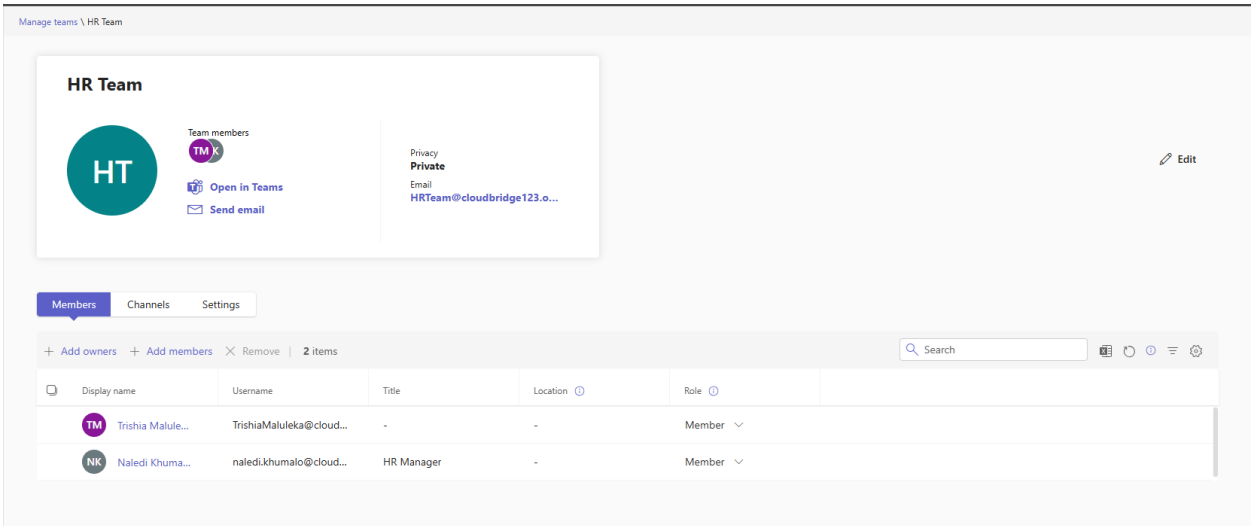


Figure 29: HR Team, a Private team with Naledi Khumalo and Trishia Maluleka as members. Membership is kept small because the team will hold sensitive HR documents.

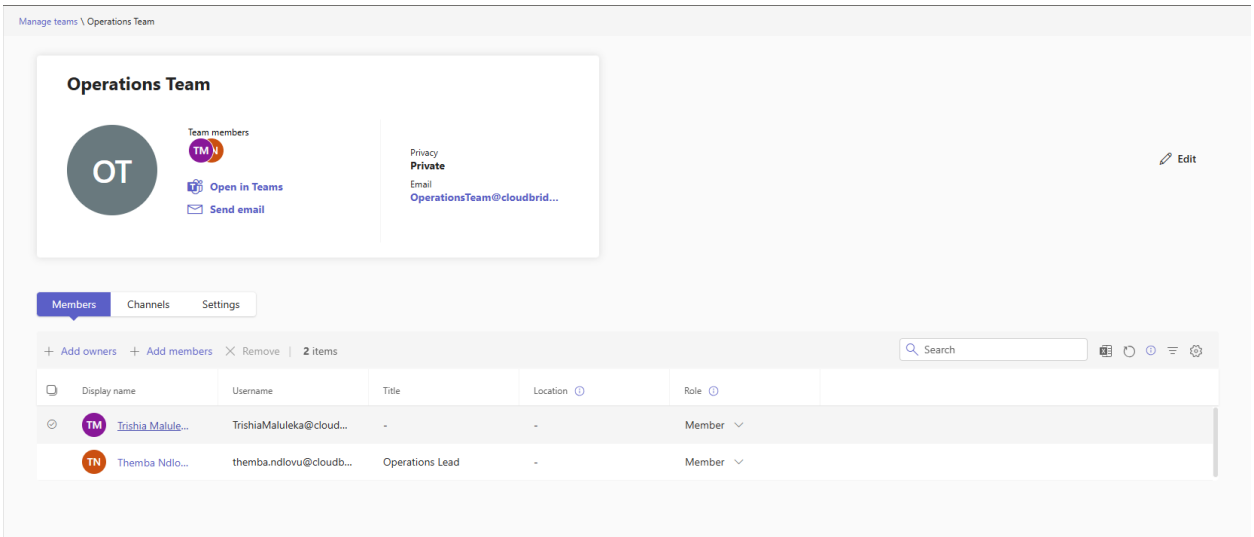


Figure 30: Operations Team, a Private team with Themba Ndlovu and Trishia Maluleka as members.

User offboarding

A leaver process was tested on a fictional employee, Zanele Mthembu. Her sign-in was blocked and her access removed first, her mailbox was converted to a shared mailbox so her mail is kept, and her license was then released.

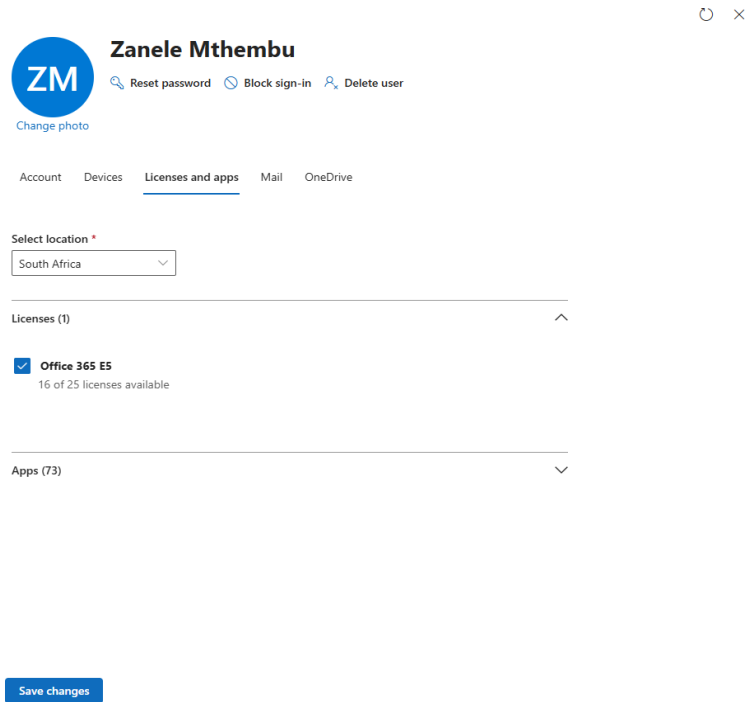


Figure 31: Zanele Mthembu's account before offboarding, showing the Office 365 E5 license assigned (16 of 25 licenses available).

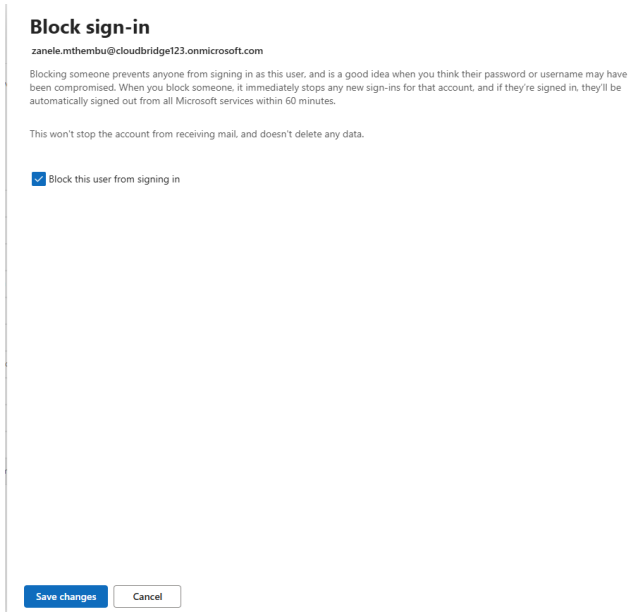


Figure 32: Block sign-in panel for the leaver account. Blocking stops new sign-ins immediately and signs the user out of Microsoft services within 60 minutes, without deleting mail or data.

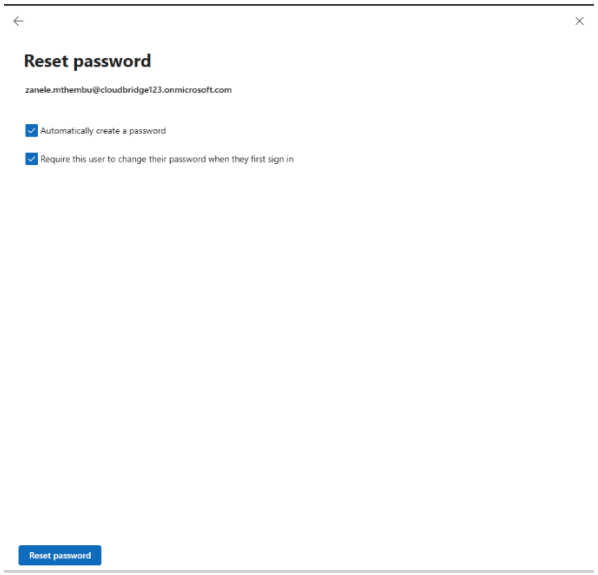


Figure 33: Reset password panel using an automatically generated password, so any password the leaver knew no longer works.

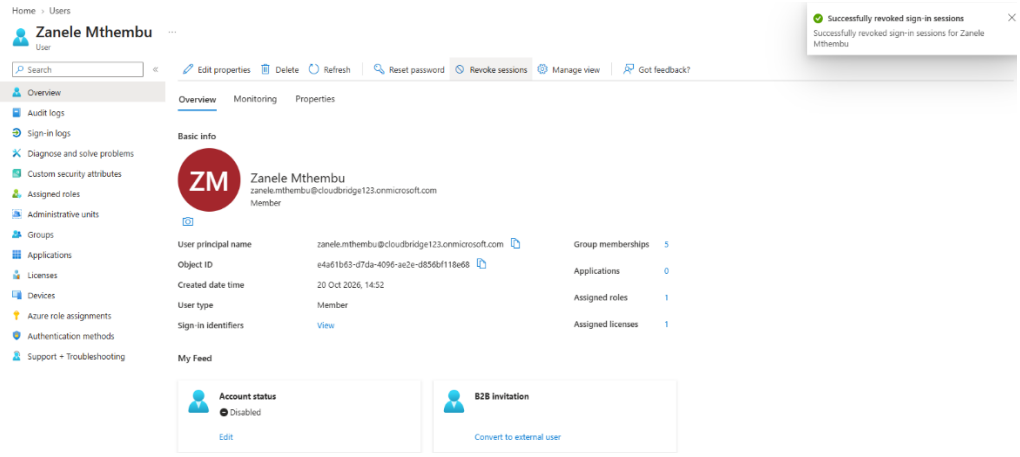


Figure 34: Zanele Mthembu's profile in the Entra admin center after the first offboarding actions: the account status is Disabled and the banner confirms her sign-in sessions were revoked. The profile still lists 5 group memberships, 1 assigned role, and 1 license, which are removed in the following steps.

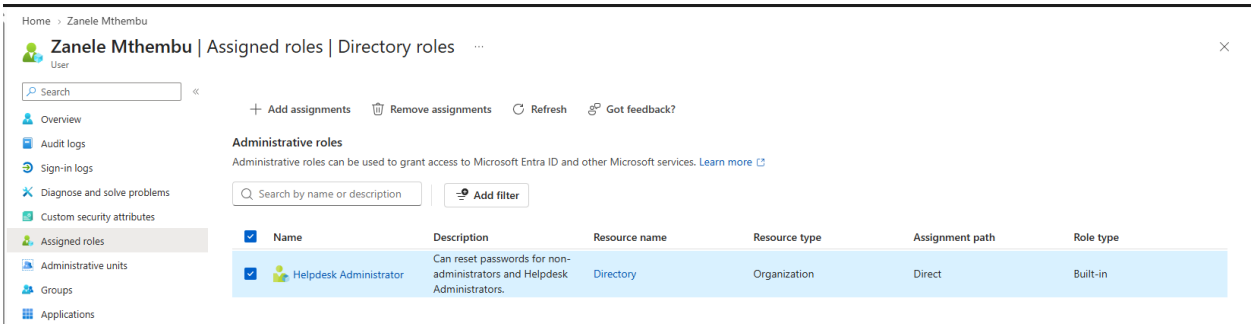


Figure 35: Assigned roles for Zanele Mthembu in Entra, showing the directly assigned Helpdesk Administrator role selected for removal.

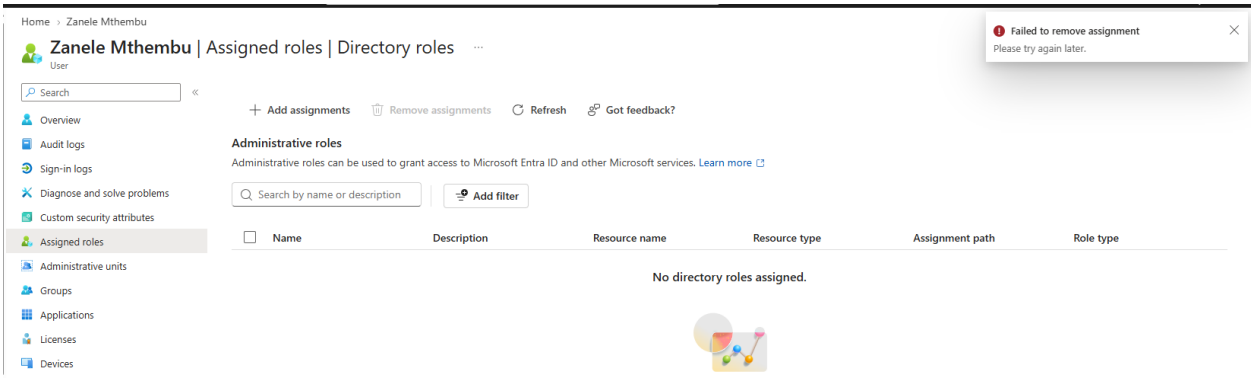


Figure 36: Assigned roles for Zanele Mthembu after the Helpdesk Administrator assignment was removed: the list shows no directory roles assigned.

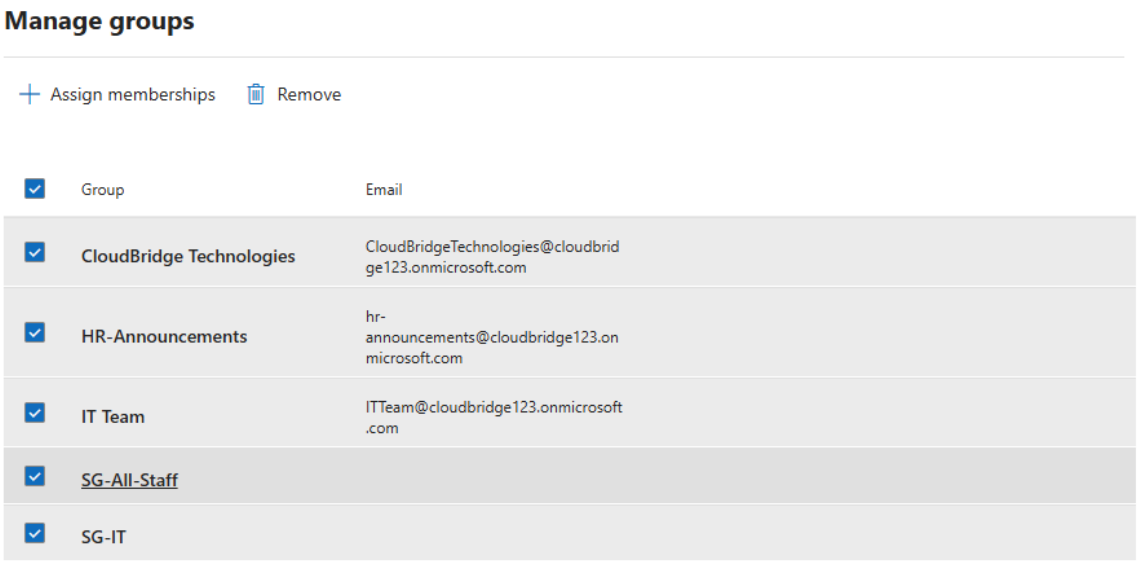


Figure 37: Manage groups panel in the Microsoft 365 admin center, listing the leaver's five memberships (CloudBridge Technologies, HR-Announcements, IT Team, SG-All-Staff and SG-IT), all selected for removal.

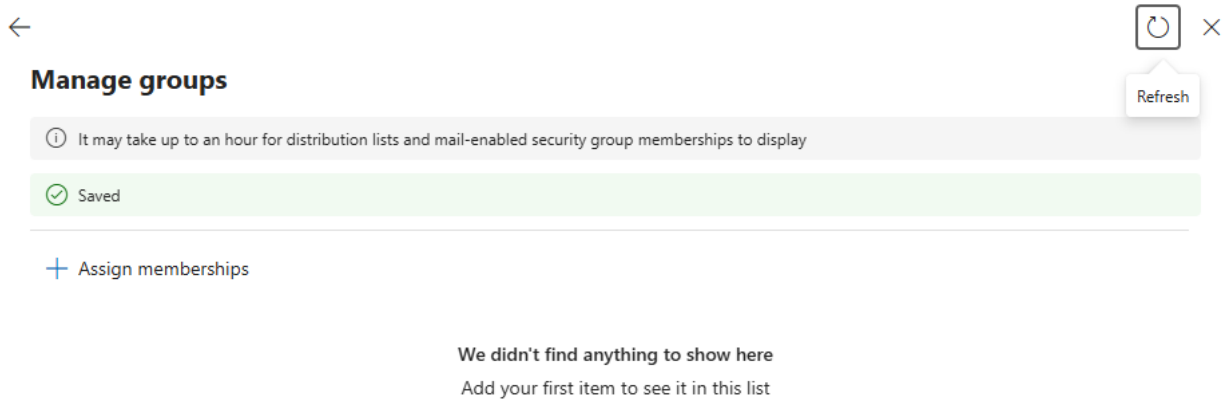


Figure 38: Manage groups panel after saving, showing the leaver has no remaining group memberships. A notice says distribution list changes can take up to an hour to display.

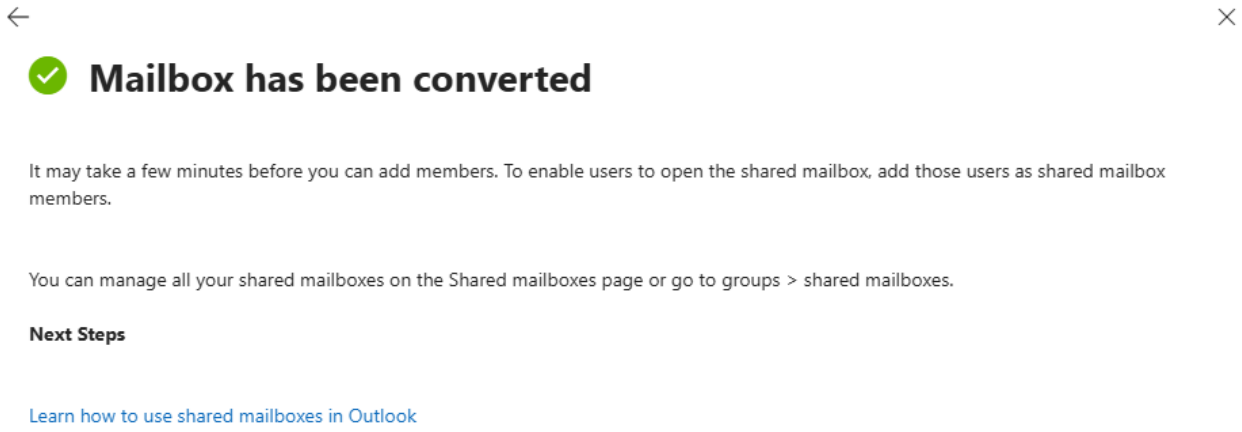


Figure 39: Confirmation that the leaver's mailbox was converted to a shared mailbox, which keeps her mail without needing a license.

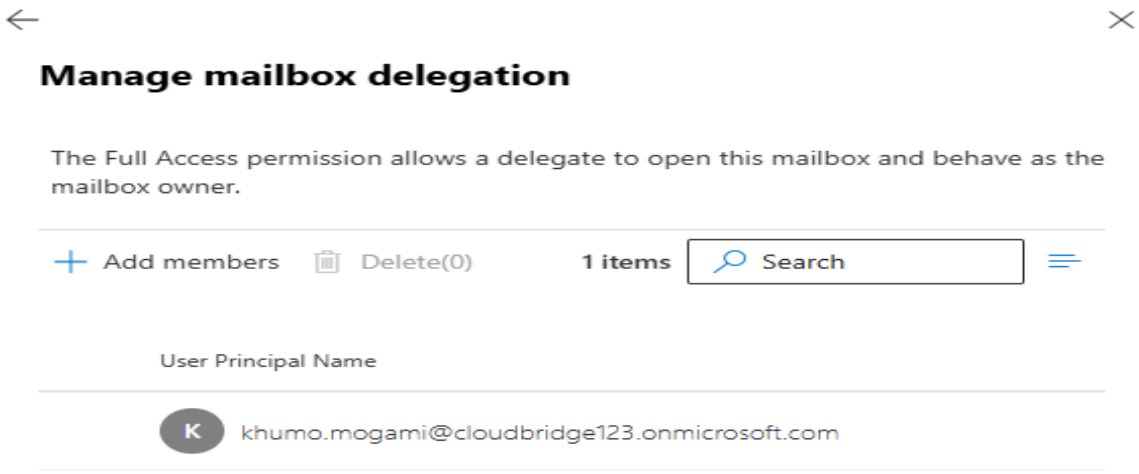


Figure 40: Full Access permission on the converted mailbox granted to Khumo Mogami, the leaver's manager, so he can open her mail after she leaves.

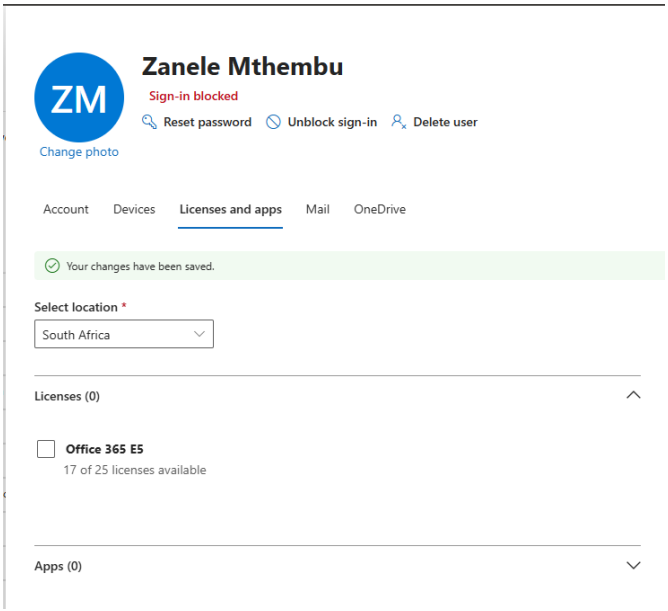


Figure 41: Zanele Mthembu's account after offboarding: sign-in is blocked, the Office 365 E5 license has been removed, and the license returned to the pool (17 of 25 available, up from 16 before offboarding).